

Ela Singh

Recommendation Systems Engineer | Search, Ranking & Retrieval

Machine learning engineer with 6.0 years of experience building ML-powered features in production. Strong background in NLP, recommendation systems, and applied AI; comfortable across the ML stack from feature engineering through deployment. Recently, I led the team that migrated our keyword-search-based product to an embedding-based retrieval. I've learned that most retrieval problems are actually evaluation problems in disguise. My academic background is in CS/ML but my main learning has come from shipping real systems and seeing what holds up under production load. Open to senior IC roles in applied ML or AI engineering, ideally at product companies where I'd own a meaningful piece of the ML stack.

Experience:

Recommendation Systems Engineer at Swiggy

2025-04-02 to None

Trained and shipped multiple ranking models for our product's discovery feed using XGBoost and LightGBM. Designed features across three families: content metadata, user behavior signals, and item engagement history. Owned the offline-online correlation analysis that determined which offline metrics actually predicted A/B test outcomes. Worked closely with PMs to define the optimization target (click-through vs. dwell time vs. downstream conversion) — that work was as important as the modeling itself.

Search Engineer at Mad Street Den

2023-10-10 to 2025-02-01

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NLP Engineer at Uber

2021-07-22 to 2023-10-10

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Applied ML Engineer at Zomato

2020-06-27 to 2021-07-22

Owned the ranking layer for an e-commerce search product, evolving it from a hand-tuned scoring function to a learning-to-rank model over 9 months. Designed the relevance labeling pipeline (mix of click-through data and explicit human judgments), the feature pipeline, and the training/eval workflow. Most of the work was infrastructure and data quality — the modeling part was almost the easy bit. Final model improved

revenue-per-search by 12%.

Skills:

Go, MLflow, FAISS, Pinecone, Angular, Image Classification, Machine Learning, Speech Recognition, Backend, MLOps, Embeddings, Information Retrieval, Hugging Face Transformers, Feature Engineering, Sentence Transformers, scikit-learn, Marketing